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Small Boy:
Oh, Mummy, Mummy, take me to school! Quick, take me to school!

Woman 8:
Take you to school? What on earth do you mean?

Small Boy:
I haven't got toothache at all. I was only joking. I just wanted to get off school. Take me to school. Mummy, please.

(Everyone laughs.)

Woman 8:
I'll take you to school all right (*Woman 8 takes the Small Boy by the ear. She drags him out.*) and I'll get the headmaster to give you a good thrashing.

(Exit Woman 8 and the Small Boy. The Small Boy is yelling.)

Man 5:
A little discipline, that's what he wants.

(Woman 5 is still showing her photographs.)

Woman 5:
This one should make quite an impression on you, dear.

(There is a loud hammering from the surgery.)

Woman 6: Yes, it does.

(Enter Nurse from the surgery).

Dentist's Voice *(off)*:
Do hurry, Nurse or we'll never get this thing shift.

(Nurse walks across the stage and off left.)

Man 6:
Well, really, I don't think I can wait.

Are You Ready ***(Standing.)***



Man 5:
Neither can I. I'll be very late for work.

(Standing.)

(Exit Man 5 and Man 6.)

Woman 6:
But surely, they can't really be using those tools to take out a tooth.

Woman 4:
You heard what the Man said.

Woman 6:
And those men have gone, too.

Man 7:
Cowards, every one of them. They can't take it.

Little Girl:
Mummy, I was only joking about my toothache, too. I haven't really got one. I was only trying to get off school.

Woman 7:
Nonsense, Dorothea, you know your tooth is as black as the kitchen range. You're only trying to get out of it.

(The Little Girl breaks into a howl.)

Man 2:
I can't stand howling children. I'm off.